Cheapify

A Smart Multi-Seller Marketplace for the Iraqi Market

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1. Problem and Solution

The Problem

- ➔ When shopping online in Iraq, the exact same item is often sold at completely different prices across various social media pages and shops.
- ➔ Buyers find it hard to trust online sellers because listings are messy, quality varies, and prices feel random.
- ➔ Local retailers want to sell online, but building and managing their own website or app is way too expensive and complicated.

The Solution

- ➔ Cheapify provides a single platform where verified local sellers list their products together under one organized catalog.
- ➔ Shoppers can instantly compare prices side by side to pick the best deal without guessing or overpaying.
- ➔ Local sellers get an easy system to reach new buyers, receive structured orders, and handle delivery smoothly.

2. Innovation in the Idea

- ➔ **Smart Price Comparison:** When multiple shops sell the exact same electronic device, gadget, or accessory, the platform groups them together to highlight the best price and seller rating.
- ➔ **Live Alerts for Sellers:** If a merchant's price is higher than others for the same item, the system notifies them so they can adjust prices and keep getting orders.
- ➔ **Built for Local Buying Habits:** Supports the payment and delivery methods people actually use, including Cash on Delivery, FastPay, Qi Card, and local delivery couriers.

3. Founder Skill: Initiative

- ➔ **My Skill:** Initiative.
- ➔ **How I Will Use It:**
  - ◆ **Building it myself:** Using my computer engineering background, I am building the website, app, and backend directly rather than waiting for funding to hire an outside software agency.
  - ◆ **Direct seller outreach:** I don't just wait for sellers to sign up; I visit local physical shops in commercial markets and actively message seller pages on Instagram and Facebook to invite them to join.
  - ◆ **Solving problems fast:** When technical bugs or operational hurdles come up, I address them immediately and find practical workarounds on my own.

4. Customer Surveys & Feedback Plan

Before Launch (Testing demand and learning needs)

- ➔ **Who to survey:** Active online shoppers, owners of physical gadget/electronics shops, and active commercial sellers on Instagram and Facebook.
- ➔ **How to conduct it:** A short 4-question Google Form shared across social media and student groups, combined with direct DMs to Instagram/Facebook business pages and quick in-person chats with store owners.
- ➔ **Simple questions for buyers:**
  - ◆ "How often do you notice huge price differences for the exact same tech item or accessory online?"
  - ◆ "What makes you hesitate the most before ordering from a social media seller?"
- ➔ **Simple questions for sellers (in-person and via DMs):**
  - ◆ "How do you currently track what competing shops charge for the same items?"
  - ◆ "Would you be interested in listing on a shared local platform that brings you orders without expensive setup fees?"

After Launch (Keeping quality high)

- ➔ **For buyers:** A quick automated WhatsApp or SMS text right after delivery asking: *"Did you receive the correct item at the agreed price?"*
- ➔ **For sellers:** A brief monthly message check-in asking: *"Are your order volumes healthy, and are delivery pick-ups happening on time?"*

5. Value the Project Gives

- ➔ **To Buyers:** Saves time and money by making it easy to find the lowest price from trusted local sellers in seconds.
- ➔ **To Sellers:** Gives physical shops and online page owners an easy sales channel that brings steady orders without taking big, painful commission cuts.
- ➔ **To the Local Market:** Makes local e-commerce safer, more transparent, and organized while supporting local retail businesses.